



EFFECTS OF ALCOHOL WITHDRAWAL



See table 1. Withdrawal symptoms may occur within 6-24 hours after last drink.

CLINICAL ASSESSMENT

Personal History: Number of days drinking in last 1 week. Quantity consumed per drinking day.

Family History: History of harmful alcohol drinking in the family.

Past medical History: Seizures, Tugging and numbness of extremities, liver disease, delirium tremens, heart disease.

- History of withdrawal symptoms including seizures
- History of difficulty breathing or white sputum

Clinical examination: Tachycardia, tremor, diaphoresis, fever, hypertension, lung crackles, ataxia.

INVESTIGATIONS (if available)

- CBC (WBC $> 10,000$)
- Liver function test (AST/ALT ratio > 1)
- Electrocardiography

5 A'S OF ALCOHOL CESSATION

Assess

Assess patient's readiness to quit. If not ready, offer brief advice and refer to quitline or other resources.

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5 R'S OF ALCOHOL CESSATION

Reasons

Encourage the patient to identify the reasons for quitting alcohol.

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CONTACT FOR ASSISTANCE

- Symptoms of withdrawal: seizures, hallucinations or delirium
(Note: In cases of severe symptoms and withdrawal symptoms with severe delirium, help and refer after stabilization dose of benzodiazepine is advised)
- Difficulty breathing or white sputum
(Note: For alcohol effects on the heart (dilated cardiomyopathy) refer to NNTL for heart failure)
- Seizures, delirium tremens
- Severe delirium tremens
- Tremor of hand
- Frequent vomiting
- Delirium tremens
- NNTL score of > 10

SEEK TELEPHONE HELP FOR ANY CLINICAL DUBTES

CONTACT US

For more information, contact the National Alcohol Helpline.



407-882-1111 / 1-800-485-1111
www.thelocalhelpline.org





TARGET POPULATION

AL 4001-1-1000-00

HIGHER-RISK POPULATION

FROM ALCOHOL WITHDRAWAL SYNDROME

- Pregnant children
- Breastfeeding
- Liver disease
- Chronic intake of regular, medicinal or recreational, include pills, drinking, herbs, street alcohol, intranasal, peroral, intravenous and subcutaneous
- Alcohol dependence syndrome

(Note: Heavy individual is at risk of alcohol dependence, but some are at a higher risk. Alcohol can amplify the effects of sedatives, causing respiratory depression and overdose.)

See 4001-1-1000-00

CAUTIONS

ALCOHOL-USE MONITORING IDENTIFICATION TEST (AMIT)

Dependence disorders are those with AMIT, not for males and not for females.

ALCOHOL-DEPENDENCE SYNDROME (ADS)

In patients dependent on alcohol, withdrawal symptoms appear 12 hours after the last drink.

- **Mild:** tremor, agitation, nausea
- **Moderate:** hallucinations
- **Severe:** confusion, disorientation, severe tremors, hot spells, sweating, fever, dehydration.

Severe can occur 12 to 48 hours after the last drink.

(Note: Not all patients who are consuming alcohol will have serious withdrawal symptoms.)

ALCOHOL IMPACT ON HEART

SYMPTOMS OF ALCOHOL CONSUMPTION INCLUDE

- Difficulty breathing, increased when lying flat
- Swollen ankles

USE THE QR CODE BELOW TO
VIEW THE 10-STEP GUIDE TO
ALCOHOL-DEPENDENCE SYNDROME
AND MONITORING IDENTIFICATION TEST



THIS IS 1 UNIT ...



Half pint (200 mL)
of regular beer



1 Small glass
of wine



1 Single measure
(20 mL) of distilled spirits

WHAT IS HARMFUL DRINKING?



Self-reported consumption of ≥ 2 standard drinks weekly per week for males (dependent is 10g ethanol)



Self-reported consumption of ≥ 1 standard drink weekly per week (dependent is 10g ethanol for females)

(See 10g amounts in 10g of pure ethanol)

Beer contains 10g, and so 10g of pure ethanol is 10g
and 10g of pure ethanol is 10g of pure ethanol.

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ALCOHOL CONSUMPTION IS A MAJOR RISK FACTOR
FOR LIVER DISEASE, HEART DISEASE, AND
ALL CAUSES OF DEATH.

See 4001-1-1000-00

OUR COLLABORATORS



HUG

HEALTH
UNIVERSITY
Glasgow

See 4001-1-1000-00



MOH
NEPAL



HARMFUL ALCOHOL CONSUMPTION IDENTIFICATION GUIDE FOR PRIMARY CARE PROVIDERS

USE THIS GUIDE TO

- ▶ IDENTIFY AND MANAGE PATIENTS WITH ALCOHOL CONSUMPTION
- ▶ MONITOR AND MANAGE PATIENTS WITH ADS

Heavy drinking often is associated with health consequences, both physically and psychologically.

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IT IS A MAJOR RISK FACTOR FOR LIVER DISEASE, HEART DISEASE, AND ALL CAUSES OF DEATH.

See 4001-1-1000-00